

BALASAI VANUKURI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics, Political Economy, Applied Econometrics.

EDUCATION

Paris School of Economics

Sept. 2022-Present

PhD in Economics

Dissertation: “Essays in Development Economics and Political Economy”

Advisors: Professor Oliver Vanden Eynde & Professor Karen Macours

Visiting Scholar, MIT, Sponsor: Professor Abhjit Banerjee

Fall 2025

Paris School of Economics

2019—2021

MRes. in Economics: Analysis and Policy in Economics, with *honors*

Advisor: Professor Karen Macours

Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi,

B.Tech & M.Tech in Chemical Engineering

2014 – 2019

Minor: Business Management

WORKING PAPERS

- “Backlash or Bonding?: Effect of Integration Policies in the Context of Affirmative Action” (JMP, Draft Available)
- “Impact of Weather Shocks on Trust in Agrarian Communities: Evidence from Rural India” (Masters Thesis, Draft Available)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- “Family Trees of Opportunity: Vertical Peer Effects and Skill Transmission in Public Universities” (with Oscar Diaz, Palaash Bhargava)
- Enabling Access to Safe Water – Evidence from Gujarat (with Vrinda Sharma)
- Transfers, Income Diversification and Climate Adaptation: Long-term Evidence (with Karen Macours, Patrick Premand, and Renos Vakis)
- Meta-analysis of On-farm and Off-farm Training Programs (with Karen Macours, Marcelo Gantier, Amit Khanal)
- Natural Disasters, Land Markets, and Inter-Religious Dynamics: Evidence from Bihar (with Oliver Vanden Eynde and Nitin Bharati)

RESEARCH GRANTS

Integration Policies in the Context of Affirmative Action

Roommates integration project and Mentoring project

- Education Policy and Social Mobility Chair Research Grant, €4,200 *2026*
- Weiss Fund for Development Economics, \$ 43,449 *2024*
- EUR-PgSE Research Grant, €4,000 *2024*
- Education Policy and Social Mobility Chair Research Grant, €5,000 *2024*
- CNRS-PSE Development Group, €4,600 *2024*
- CEPREMAP Research Grant, €5,000 *2024*
- CNRS-PSE Development Group, €3,000 *2023*
- CEPREMAP Research Grant, €3,000 *2023*

Safe Water Access (Joint with Vrinda Sharma)

- Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Pilot Grant, \$ 15,500 2026
- CNRS-PSE Development Group, €7,000 2026
- EUR-PgSE Research Grant, €1,500 2026
- SurveyCTO Primary Data Collection Research Grant, €1,000 2026
- CNRS-PSE Development Group, €4,000 2025

EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS

2026: World Inequality Conference, QUML PhD Workshop, NOVAFRICA Conference, Nordic Conference on Development Economics, Minorities in Economics Conference, CEPR Economics Job Market Bootcamp

2025: MIT Behavioral Seminar, Development Political Economy Seminar, Northeastern University brown bag, Tufts University PhD Seminar

2023: India China Conference, University of Namur

2022: India China Conference, PSE

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Short-Term Consultant, World Bank (Development Impact Group) Feb 2026 – Jun 2026
- Research Consultant, Warwick Business School (Prof. Giorgia Barboni) Apr 2023 – Dec 2025
- Tobin Pre-doctoral Fellow, Yale University (Prof. Rohini Pande) Jul 2021 – Aug 2022
- External Consultant, OECD (Dr. Carlotta Balestra and Dr. Emanuele Ciani) Dec 2020 – Jan 2021
- Research Assistant, PSE (Prof. Liam Wren-Lewis and Prof. Oliver Vanden Eynde) Jul 2020 – Aug 2020
- Research Assistant, PSE (Prof. Karen Macours) Jun 2019 – Aug 2019
- Teaching Assistant (ATER), Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne Sep 2026 – Aug 2027
- Teaching Assistant, Econometrics I, PSE (Prof. Karen Macours) 2022, 2023

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Programming: *Journal of Development Economics*

SKILLS

Programming: STATA (advanced), R (advanced), L^AT_EX (advanced), Google Earth Engine/Java Script (Intermediate), Arc/Q-GIS (basic), Python (basic)

Online Courses: [MicroMasters in Data, Economics, and Development Policy \(MIT\)](#)

Languages: Telugu (native), Hindi (advanced), English (advanced), French (intermediate – B1)

AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

Doctoral Contract ED 465 (Paris 1 Pantheon-Sorbonne) 2022
Recipient of a Full Scholarship to study at The Paris School of Economics

Master APE Scholarship (Paris School of Economics) 2020
Recipient of 5000 euros scholarship to study at the Paris School of Economics

Charpak Master BCS Scholarship (French Government) 2020

Summer Undergraduate Research Award (IIT Delhi) 2016
Received funding of 15,000 INR and stipend of 6000 INR to pursue research on catalysis at IIT Delhi

REFERENCES

Karen Macours PhD, *Professor, Paris School of Economics* | karen.macours@psemail.eu

Oliver Vanden Eynde PhD, *Professor, Paris School of Economics* | o.vandeneynde@psemail.eu

Liam Wren Lewis PhD, *Professor, Paris School of Economics* | liam.wren-lewis@psemail.eu

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